Majesty finished saying the thousand and one names of the "Greater Luminary", and stepped out into the balcony, than the whole crowd prostrated themselves.'

From these many experiences of God there arose in Akbar a desire for harmony, as opposed to the conflict and the disharmony of the earlier ibadat khana discussions. Abu'l Fazl would make it his life's work to articulate and expand upon this notion in his biography of Akbar, which he would begin to write in a few years. 'As the world's Lord exercises sway over it on the principle of sulh kul, universal civility,' wrote Abu'l Fazl, 'every group of people can live in accordance with its own doctrine without apprehension, and everyone can worship God after his own fashion.' This spirit of harmony, present also in the Bhakti and Sufi movements, as well as the pantheistic philosophy of Ibn Arabi, did not, as historian Harbans Mukhia has shown, just prescribe a passive 'tolerance' of all religions but was an active ideological state. In his work Abu'l Fazl blames the 'blowing of the chill blast of inflexible custom and the low…lamp of wisdom' for being the cause of disharmony whereas 'if the doctrine of an enemy be in itself good, why should hands be stained in the blood of its professors? And even were it otherwise, the sufferer from the malady of folly deserves commiseration, not hostility and the shedding of his blood.' For Akbar, it would appear that after all his experiments and his ecstatic visions, he was beginning to relate to a concept of divinity as described in the teachings of the Nirguna Bhakti. In a letter to Murad, written in 1591, Akbar told his son:

> Devotion to the Matchless one is beyond the limits of the spoken word whether in respect of form, material attributes, letter or sound. Devotion to the Matchless one is also matchless.

The influence of these thoughts in governance, especially through the works of Tusi and Rumi, which were among Akbar's favourite texts, has also been pointed out by scholars. Akbar was particularly fond of Rumi's *Masnavi*, reciting them from memory. One such masnavi, which seemed to reflect Akbar's deepest convictions, was:

> Thou has come to unite
> Not to separate
> For the people of Hind, the idiom of Hindi is praiseworthy